MANATOBI / ORIGINAL PRACTICE

英検準1級
リーディングトレーニング

第4回 問題冊子

リスニング・英作文を含まない部分練習 ／ 全31問

大問	問題番号	内容
1	1〜18	短文の語句空所補充
2	19〜24	長文の語句空所補充
3	25〜31	読解

使い方

・解答用紙に答えを記入してください。問題冊子には正答を載せていません。
・問題・解説はA4縦、解答用紙はA4横。白黒・片面・実際のサイズ（100%）で印刷します。
・解き終わるまでは、別冊の解答・解説を開かないでください。
・同じ問題をアプリの分野別練習でも解けます。

独自作成した英検準1級形式のリーディング第4回です。リスニング・英作文・面接は含みません。公式教材ではなく、CSE・合否換算はしません。筆記全体の公式時間をリーディングだけの時間に流用しません。外部難度校正は未実施です。

氏名：＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿

1

短文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

(1) The safety audit revealed that lax supervision had allowed minor shortcuts to become ( ) across all three assembly lines.

1 deferential **2** pervasive **3** ephemeral **4** placid

(2) Although the minister promised sweeping reform, the final bill offered only ( ) adjustments to existing tax brackets.

1 insolvent **2** incendiary **3** immutable **4** incremental

(3) To keep raw sewage from entering the bay during cloudbursts, the city built vast underground tanks to ( ) peak runoff.

1 impound **2** impugn **3** implore **4** impart

(4) The curator's ( ) notes on provenance helped investigators trace the bronze vessel back to a looted riverside tomb.

1 arbitrary **2** apathetic **3** assiduous **4** audacious

(5) Far from settling the boundary dispute, the hastily drafted map became a fresh source of ( ) between the two parishes.

1 concession **2** contention **3** complacency **4** clemency

(6) Because Alpine weather can deteriorate within minutes, hut wardens urge climbers not to treat sunny forecasts with ( ).

1 cohesion **2** circumspection **3** complacency **4** candor

(7) The tribunal dismissed the memo as ( ) to the patent claim, noting that it had been written five years after the invention.

1 equivocal **2** exemplary **3** endemic **4** extraneous

(8) Years of overgrazing had ( ) the hillside pastures of deep-rooted grasses, leaving bare clay exposed to monsoon rains.

1 denuded **2** deluded **3** defrayed **4** deposed

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(9) Even critics of the ferry merger conceded that unifying ticket platforms had eliminated a (　　) array of regional surcharges.

1 blithe　**2** buoyant　**3** benign　**4** bewildering

(10) To protect whistleblowers from retaliation, the ombudsman's office is legally empowered to keep informants' identities (　　).

1 conjectural　**2** confidential　**3** conspicuous　**4** contentious

(11) The chemist warned that trace copper impurities could (　　) the catalyst, halting the reaction after only a few hours.

1 ventilate　**2** venerate　**3** vitiate　**4** vindicate

(12) Rather than impose a uniform curriculum overnight, the ministry opted for a (　　) rollout across volunteer districts.

1 phased　**2** puerile　**3** punitive　**4** precarious

(13) The archival parchment was so (　　) after centuries in dry storage that conservators humidified it before unfolding a single crease.

1 bountiful　**2** brittle　**3** brazen　**4** banal

(14) Public hearings revealed a stark (　　) between the developer's glossy traffic projections and residents' daily gridlock.

1 dichotomy　**2** deference　**3** decorum　**4** digression

(15) When negotiations threatened to collapse over harbour tariffs, the chair adjourned the session to let tempers (　　).

1 supersede　**2** succumb　**3** surmise　**4** subside

(16) The novelist's early essays were dismissed as (　　), yet they anticipated media debates that emerged thirty years later.

1 lucrative　**2** compliant　**3** esoteric　**4** mundane

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(17) Hospital pharmacists check every prescription twice so that look-alike drug names do not (　　) busy night-shift wards.

1 drum up　**2** trip up　**3** shore up　**4** bottle up

(18) After the textile mill closed, town leaders struggled to (　　) new employers that could match its skilled wages.

1 bear out　**2** brush off　**3** bail out　**4** bring in

2

長文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Why Faster Roads Sometimes Slow Cities Down

When commuters sit bumper to bumper on a ring road, widening the highway by an extra lane looks like straightforward relief. Traffic engineers in the mid-twentieth century treated cars much like water in a pipe: enlarge the channel, and congestion should drain away. Decades of metropolitan data, however, exposed a stubborn surprise known as induced demand. Within a few years of a major road expansion, rush-hour speeds frequently return to their previous crawl.

The mechanism is behavioral rather than mysterious. A congested corridor deters dozens of borderline trips: some residents take the train, others shop closer to home, and delivery firms schedule trucks before dawn. Once new asphalt temporarily cuts travel times, all those deferred choices shift onto the road simultaneously. Longer commutes also begin to look tolerable, encouraging housing developments farther from town centers. Capacity additions thus (19).

Even more counterintuitively, removing or narrowing selected urban arteries has sometimes improved overall mobility. When cities converted deteriorated elevated highways into tree-lined boulevards paired with frequent rail service, feared traffic collapses rarely materialized. Some trips vanished, others moved to transit, and local streets flowed more predictably without highway ramps dumping surges of vehicles into narrow intersections. (20), planners increasingly evaluate transport investments by how many destinations citizens can reach within thirty minutes rather than how fast cars move on a single stretch of pavement.

Road maintenance and freight links remain vital, of course. Yet treating road space as part of a wider land-use and transit ecosystem helps municipalities (21) instead of chasing congestion with ever-wider concrete.

(19)

1 generate the very traffic that eventually consumes them
2 persuade suburban residents to sell their automobiles
3 keep housing construction strictly inside historic cores
4 force delivery trucks to operate only after midnight

(20)

1 Conversely
2 Otherwise
3 Accordingly
4 Nonetheless

(21)

1 abolish freight deliveries to commercial districts
2 design lasting accessibility across multiple modes
3 guarantee sixty-kilometer-per-hour driving on every lane
4 measure civic success by concrete volume alone

When Historical Maps Guide Modern Ecological Restoration

Ecologists asked to restore degraded wetlands or floodplains often confront a baseline puzzle: what did a "healthy" landscape actually look like before industrial drainage and embankment? Living memory rarely stretches back more than seventy years, so river valleys straightened in the nineteenth century can appear entirely natural to current residents.

Archival cartography has emerged as an unexpected scientific ally. Military surveyors, tax assessors, and estate engineers working two or three centuries ago recorded marsh boundaries, oxbow ponds, and coppiced woodlands with painstaking care—not out of environmental concern, but because taxable pasture, timber yields, and troop crossings depended on ground conditions. Digitizing and layering those hand-drawn sheets over modern satellite elevation models reveals vanished channels that still subtly govern where floodwater pools after storms. (22), restoration teams can reconnect buried meanders rather than digging artificial ponds in arbitrary spots.

Old maps require critical interpretation, of course. Early surveyors occasionally exaggerated cliff heights, omitted seasonal brooks dry in August, or used land categories whose meanings shifted over generations. Cross-checking maps against sediment cores, pollen grains, and parish flood chronicles prevents planners from mistaking a surveyor's shorthand for literal truth. (23), recognizing that preindustrial landscapes were themselves shaped by grazing, reed cutting, and small millponds reminds conservationists that ecosystems were rarely untouched wilderness.

Historical baselines cannot—and should not—be copied mechanically under a warming climate. Rather, reading archival maps alongside field data helps communities (24) while designing landscapes resilient enough for future extremes.

(22)

1 Otherwise
2 Despite such precision
3 Armed with these clues
4 On the contrary

(23)

1 Previously
2 Instead
3 Otherwise
4 Moreover

(24)

1 work with inherited hydrological patterns
2 freeze every river valley in its eighteenth-century state
3 discard satellite elevation data altogether
4 drain remaining marshes for tax revenue

3 長文の内容一致選択
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

The Paradox of Ultra-Clean Seed Coats

Modern commercial agriculture prizes clean, uniform seed lots. Before vegetable or grain seeds reach farm drills, industrial processing lines wash, polish, and often coat them with antimicrobial treatments so fungal pathogens cannot rot young sprouts in cold spring soil. Eliminating seed-borne blights has prevented devastating crop losses over the past century. Yet plant microbiologists studying how seedlings establish roots have uncovered a subtle trade-off: stripping every microbe from a seed's surface can also remove beneficial bacteria and fungi that parent plants pass to their offspring.

In wild relatives and traditional farm-saved seed, microscopic grooves on the seed coat harbor diverse communities of endophytes—organisms that enter emerging roots without causing disease. Controlled greenhouse experiments show that seedlings carrying their native microbial partners often solubilize soil phosphorus more efficiently, tolerate brief droughts better, and crowd out opportunistic root pathogens through sheer competition for space and sugars. When seeds are sterilized indiscriminately and planted into heavily tilled soil, young roots must recruit helpful microbes from scratch during their most vulnerable week.

Developing "microbiome-friendly" seed care is far trickier than simply abandoning hygiene, however. Untreated seed lots can spread virulent bacterial cankers across entire regions in a single season, a risk no commercial grower can accept. Researchers are therefore testing selective thermal treatments—such as precisely timed aerated steam—that neutralize heat-sensitive surface pathogens while sparing tougher beneficial spores deeper in the coat, followed by re-inoculating seeds with tailored consortia of benign root microbes.

Field performance of biological seed coatings remains variable, because introduced bacteria that thrive in greenhouse pots sometimes struggle against resident microbes in alkaline clay or sandy loam. Even so, viewing a seed not as a sterile genetic capsule but as a miniature ecological package is reshaping how breeders and pathologists define seed quality.

The Paradox of Ultra-Clean Seed Coats — Questions

(25) What trade-off in modern industrial seed processing does the author highlight?

1 Washing seeds removes genetic traits needed for photosynthesis.

2 Polished seeds germinate faster in summer but fail to sprout in spring.

3 Antimicrobial coatings double seed weight and jam farm machinery.

4 Removing all surface microbes prevents serious diseases yet also strips away helpful organisms inherited from parent plants.

(26) How do native endophytes carried on unsterilized seeds assist young seedlings?

1 They dissolve clay rocks into pure rainwater.

2 They aid nutrient uptake, improve drought tolerance, and compete against root pathogens.

3 They raise soil temperature by five degrees during spring frosts.

4 They prevent parent plants from producing extra grooves on seed coats.

(27) Why can commercial agriculture NOT simply stop sanitizing seeds altogether?

1 Farmers are legally required to color every seed bright blue.

2 Greenhouse pots cannot hold traditional farm-saved varieties.

3 Untreated seed batches could rapidly spread destructive plant diseases across wide farming areas.

4 Unwashed seeds lose their ability to absorb water within days.

Why Hospital Alarms Needed Quiet Reform

Intensive-care wards are filled with devices designed to save lives by demanding immediate attention: heart monitors, infusion pumps, ventilators, and oxygen sensors each carry their own acoustic alert. Taken individually, setting every machine to beep at the slightest deviation from normal appears prudent—better ten false warnings than one missed emergency. Multiplied across twenty beds, however, cautious thresholds produce hundreds of chimes per shift, creating a phenomenon clinicians call "alarm fatigue."

Studies observing hospital floors found that between eighty and ninety-five percent of audible alerts required no clinical intervention; many were triggered when a waking patient shifted position, a finger clip slipped slightly, or a parameter crossed a boundary for three seconds before self-correcting. Exposed to a relentless stream of non-urgent beeps, human brains inevitably adapt by filtering out background noise—or staff silence loud panels hurriedly while tending another task, increasing the danger that a genuinely critical warning blends into the din.

Addressing alarm fatigue required changing both engineering defaults and ward culture. Several medical centers began by auditing which alerts occurred most frequently without ever leading to treatment changes. Simply widening overly tight default thresholds by a small, clinically safe margin—and adding a ten-second delay so brief movement artifacts could clear—cut daily non-actionable alarms by nearly half without compromising patient safety. Equally important was replacing daily reuse of dried adhesive electrodes, which often caused erratic false readings, with fresh sensor pads every morning.

Manufacturers have simultaneously redesigned soundscapes using psychoacoustics. Instead of shrill, identical square-wave tones that startle everyone in the corridor, newer standards group alerts by physiological system and reserve piercing rhythms strictly for life-threatening events, while routing routine equipment notices—such as a nearly empty saline bag—quietly to nurses' handheld badges.

Safer monitoring ultimately came not from louder sirens, but from respecting human attention as a finite clinical resource.

Why Hospital Alarms Needed Quiet Reform — Questions

(28) How did setting ultra-sensitive defaults on individual medical devices create a ward-wide hazard?

1 Combined across many beds, frequent non-urgent beeps desensitized staff and risked masking real emergencies.

2 Patients learned how to turn off their own ventilators at night.

3 The machines interfered electrically with hospital lighting circuits.

4 Loud chimes caused infusion pumps to deliver medication twice as fast.

(29) What did observational studies reveal about the majority of audible alerts on hospital floors?

1 Nearly ninety percent indicated life-threatening cardiac events.

2 Over eighty percent stemmed from harmless shifts, loose sensors, or brief self-correcting fluctuations.

3 They occurred only during power outages in winter.

4 Nurses ignored them because they were too quiet to hear.

(30) Which practical change helped hospitals cut non-actionable alarms by nearly half?

1 Slightly widening safe thresholds, adding a brief delay, and replacing sensor pads daily.

2 Removing heart monitors from intensive-care beds during daytime shifts.

3 Hiring extra staff solely to write down every beep in a paper ledger.

4 Turning up the volume of every corridor speaker by twenty decibels.

(31) How do newer psychoacoustic alarm standards handle routine equipment notices like low saline bags?

1 They sound a piercing siren throughout the entire hospital wing.

2 They flash strobe lights above the patient's pillow.

3 They delay notifying anyone until the next morning's shift change.

4 They send quiet notifications to nurses' handheld badges while reserving sharp tones for critical threats.